

Rahul Vedula

Designing a better tomorrow, one click at a time!

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[Rahul Vedula - Principal Product Designer - Cactus | LinkedIn UX Design Awards 2026](#)

Overview

I'm Rahul Vedula, a passionate product design leader with over a decade of experience crafting impactful **B2C and B2B experiences**. My expertise lies in designing for **AI-powered products, SaaS platforms, enterprise tools, and e-commerce ecosystems**. Over the years, I've worked across diverse industries — from **EdTech and energy to media, healthcare, IoT, blockchain, and agritech** — always focused on solving business challenges through a user-first lens. I thrive in collaborative environments, believe in mentoring and supporting teams, and continuously seek opportunities to learn, grow, and deliver meaningful product outcomes.

Key Accomplishments

Cactus Communications

- Played a pivotal role in the journey of ~5.5Mn revenue for [Paperpal](#).
- Designed a **scalable Information Architecture (IA)** for the **Paperpal Web Editor** that laid the foundation for **seamless expansion to MS Word, Google Docs, and Overleaf extensions**—enabling **consistent user experience and efficient feature integration** across platforms.
- Led key initiatives including the **revamp of the Paperpal Editor Experience, AA-level Accessibility compliance**, and **Strapi implementation** to support rapid landing page experiments.
- Drove a **~42% increase in feature activation** by designing **intent-based user onboarding flows**.
- Redesigned the [RDiscovery](#) homepage with a search-first approach, **boosting search engagement by over 223%**.
- **Leveraged data insights** to propose the **Quarterly Plan** option, now widely adopted across products—contributing to higher Average Order Value (AOV).

Simplilearn- B2B-Enterprise

- Reduced **10 working hours per week** for CSMs (Customer Success Managers) by simplifying the most critical workflows.
- Achieved **100% CSM adoption of the platform** in usage of License management and reports.
- Relevant reports and dashboard views improved the **licenses usage by 27%**

Simplilearn -B2C

- **Increased completion rates** of the learners by **22%** through a holistic redesign of the omnichannel communication experience & enhancing LMS experience
- Increased **T/L ratio** for targeted program pages from **2.3% to 3.7%**.
- Through the implementation of redesigned learning journeys, we witnessed a remarkable increase in the upskilling percentage, soaring from 13% to 30%.

Collej

- Played an instrumental role in launching the **go-to-market (GTM) strategy** for Collej.
- Achieved successful enrollments for three cohorts, indicating the effectiveness of our approach in attracting and retaining learners.

Sustain Impact - B2B Enterprise

- Conducted Proof of Concepts (POCs) with esteemed energy companies in India, including **BSES Rajdhani Power** (Reliance Group), **CESE Ltd** (Goenka Group), and

UX METHODS

Design Thinking,
Persona & Scenario
Journey maps, Concept maps
User Research
Heuristic Evaluation
Contextual Inquiry
Usability Study
Website Analytics (Heatmaps, Scroll maps, Click Analysis)
Affinity Mapping,
User Flows,
Wireframing, Sketching,
Experience Prototyping

TOOLS

Figma, Figjam
Miro Board
Sketch
Invision
Framer
UXPin
Adobe Photoshop

Other Tools
MATLAB, Xilinx, Altium,
Multisim

AWARDS

[UX Design Awards 2026 Nomination](#)

Smart Startup of the Year
2021 - ISGF

MENTORSHIP

Designed.org

Collej UX Community

Tata Power.

- Designed **IoT and Blockchain** enabled Automated Demand Response (**DR**) **Enterprise application for Energy companies** which are capable of handling the **Smart contracts**.

Sustain Impact - Consumer App

- Launched consumer facing android **Peer-Peer Trading application**.
- Won the **Smart Startup of the Year 2021 award** from ISGF.

UX Reactor

- Led some of the most successful client engagements
 - Enterprise & SAAS Clients: **VMWare(Velocloud)**-SDWAN, ClearGage, Storage-i
 - B2C - **CDW, UserTesting**, SiliconAngle, CUBE
- Instrumental in setting up **UX Research and Design QA** team ground-up

EDUCATION

Swinburne University of Technology, Melbourne — *M.Tech Electrical & Electronics*

March 2013 - October 2014

JNTU, Hyderabad — *B.Tech Electronics and Communications*

October 2007 - June 2011

CERTIFICATIONS

Harvard Business School Online — *Management Essentials*

(Previously known as Becoming Better Manager)

NN/g (Nielsen Norman Group) — *UX Management*

(TheUX VP/Director, Designing Influence, Research Ops, Managing UX Strategy, Facilitating UX Workshops)

EXPERIENCE

Cactus Communications — *Principal Product Designer* (November 2023 - Present)

Driving Design across all the Product Suite Paperpal, Rdiscovery, Editage All access, Mind the Graph, my responsibilities include achieving the business goals by collaborating with product, tech and marketing leaders, I have to co-create the GEM plans and roadmaps by working with C-level leadership. My role focuses on nurturing a strong design culture that promotes learning, transparency, and growth—through initiatives like Design Thinking workshops, critique sessions, user interview watch parties, and SME-led design sessions. Currently coaching and guiding a team of 11 designers spanning all levels of experience (3 lead product designers, 2 Sr. Product designers, 3 Product designers and 3 Associate Product Designers)

- **AI Solutions:** Designed the AI feature platform which enables B2B clients to experience the feature and request for services which meet their business requirements.
- **Paperpal and Pre-Flight:** Introduced value added nudges by seamlessly adding suitable human services along with the reports which created an additional stream of **~6k revenue** with its limited rollout. This will soon scale 10X in coming quarters.
- Enabling subscription pause and crafting thoughtful winback flows contributed to a **positive ~12% reduction in churn**, enhancing user retention.
- Initiated conducting **user research** in labs (at Universities and Research Institutions) not only helped in solving the usability issues but also gave valuable insights in shaping the feature.
- **Led workshops and represented the company** at **IEEE APSCON (IIT Hyderabad)**, positioning Cactus as an AI-first innovator in research tools.

Simplilearn — *Sr.Associate Director UX Design* (March 2022 - October 2023)

Leading across all 3 product lines, my role involves collaboration with product, tech, and business teams to establish roadmaps. I define design strategies, oversee design sprints, participate in brainstorming and critique sessions, lead

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research studies, and engage in design sessions with designers. I conduct User Acceptance Testing (UAT), mentor individuals, and ensure high-quality design delivery. Mentored and led a team of 9 designers which includes 2 UX leads, 2 Senior UX designers, 2 Visual Designers and 3 UX Designers across all the product lines.

- **Platform Product** focuses on engagement and completion with a 77K MAU. For B2B - SAAS platforms and Internal Admin tools, efficiency and ease of use are key.
- **Growth Product**, we aim to improve the T/L Ratio of Websites and University Subdomains with ~ 4 million monthly visitors.
- **Skillup (Freemium)** primary focus is retention and engagement for a 1 million+ user base.

Simplilearn - UX Lead (June 2021 - December 2021)

I was entrusted with the responsibility of enhancing engagement and optimizing the learner experience within the Learning Management System (LMS).

- Elevated satisfaction rating of **learning support experience from 3.3 to 4.1**.
- Doubled user engagement through effective design interventions.

Collej, UX Consultant (October 2020 - May 2021)

At Collej, a startup with a mission to revolutionize careers for designers and simplify design hiring processes for the industry, I played a pivotal role in developing the strategy and executing the end-to-end learner experience.

- Responsible for creating strategy and design execution for the learner experience, covering all stages from **Awareness to Advocacy**
- Worked closely with the Founder to develop and implement key initiatives.

Sustain Impact, Co-founder

May 2019 - June 2021

Co-founder Experience: Embracing the role of a co-founder for the first time was a transformative journey. In addition to designing and launching the product, I gained valuable insights through **diverse responsibilities such as investor and academia pitching, budget management, and customer relations**.

This experience provided me with a holistic understanding of various aspects of business operations beyond design. It served as a **remarkable opportunity for personal and professional growth**.

UXReactor, UX Consultant (February 2015 - May 2019)

In my capacity, I spearheaded numerous client engagements, curating **a diverse portfolio encompassing B2B, B2C, and UX Training initiatives**. Central to my role was the **orchestration of project kickoffs, customized UX Design planning, effective engagement management, and the facilitation of seamless project handovers**. This comprehensive involvement not only drew upon my personal expertise but also involved cultivating the team's prowess in these critical areas.

My impact was particularly pronounced **in the establishment of QA and UX Research Centers of Excellence (COEs)**, underscoring my adeptness in structuring and leading impactful teams. With a background in a design consulting firm, I exhibited a versatile approach, leveraging adaptable design methodologies attuned to the unique exigencies of each client and project. Spearheaded client engagements for enterprise giants like **VMWare (Velocloud SDWAN) and UserTesting**.

Conducting collaborative workshops at client sites, I fostered cohesion among Product, Sales, Engineering, Marketing, Data, and Leadership teams, streamlining handoffs through comprehensive dev files. My journey underscores personal growth and the ability to shape exceptional design while nurturing emerging design leaders.